



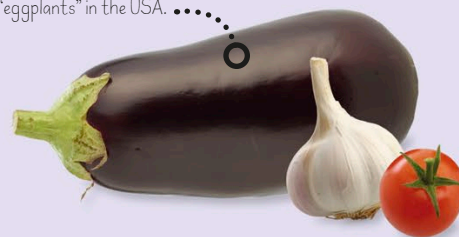
INGREDIENTS

- 4 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 medium onion, finely chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, finely chopped

- 2 x 400g (14oz) cans chopped tomatoes
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- 1 tsp sugar
- 2 medium aubergines, approx. 600g (1lb 5oz)
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper

- 100g (3½oz) grated mozzarella cheese

Aubergines are called "eggplants" in the USA.



1 PREHEAT THE OVEN to 190°C (375°F/Gas 5). Heat 1 tbsp of oil in a pan and cook the onion for 5 minutes. Add the garlic and cook a further minute.



2 ADD THE TOMATOES to the pan. Add the oregano and sugar and season with salt and pepper. Bring to a simmer and cook for 20 minutes.



3 CUT THE AUBERGINE into slices 5mm (¼in) thick. Brush the aubergine slices on each side with the remaining oil and season with salt and pepper.



4 HEAT A GRIDDLE PAN, then working in batches over a medium heat, brown the aubergines for 2–3 minutes on each side until tender. Set aside.



5 DIVIDE A THIRD of the tomato sauce into 4 dishes, then add 3–4 slices of aubergine. Repeat this process then finish with a layer of sauce on the top.



6 SCATTER THE CHEESE over the top. Cook in the oven to bake for 25 minutes or until the tops are golden brown and bubbling.